

Recommended buys

The very best products you can buy right now spanning across 10 popular tech categories.



Rename 'Autopilot' mode

Germany has asked Tesla to rename the 'Autopilot' feature to a more appropriate term for its driver assist system in the newer cars. <http://digit.in/TSPRnme>

Agent 001

it? Small screen, small budget or big screen, no holds barred? A home laptop ideally has to be the jack of all trades. It has to satisfy differing needs of people in the house. A homemaker would want to just browse Facebook posts and videos on it all day or watch movies, keeping the laptop plugged in all the time. Or she may want to use the laptop in the kitchen to watch cooking videos, thereby desiring greater battery life and ultraportability. There are no easy choices, only tradeoffs to consider.

It isn't absolutely necessary for a home laptop to sport the latest, fastest hardware. For example, it's okay if you can't get an Intel Core i5 or Core i7 CPU, DDR4 RAM, 7200 rpm HDD, NVIDIA or AMD graphics, or Full HD display on your laptop. For basic home use, a laptop with an Intel Core i3 processor, DDR3 RAM, 5400 rpm HDD, onboard Intel HD graphics or 1366x768 pixel resolution screen is more than enough – if you're just going to be using the laptop for browsing the Internet and watching downloaded movies for the most part. This can help save you money. Or look for other unique features that you can't fit into your budget – like a touchscreen panel, multiple USB 3.0 ports, DVD writer, licensed Windows OS, etc.

While shopping for a home laptop that looks good, choosing a machine that looks good – with an attractive screen lid, aesthetic colour combo – something that's not dull, boring or black will come at a price. It won't be the cheapest laptop around and functionality may not always be prioritized. For example, a cute looking laptop may not necessarily be built well; if it has a glossy or smooth bottom panel without rubber stoppers it won't grip any surface assuredly. Be wise in your choice.

Why a gaming laptop can't deliver high-speed performance and great battery life simultaneously

Great gaming performance or superior battery life? It's a classic Catch 22! For gamers, only the best hardware will do. The best hardware, super-sized... to

the max. Pimp the specs out, everything overloaded. Why? Cuz that's how you bring the latest and greatest games kicking and screaming down to their knees.

And therein lies one crucial tradeoff.

Running games smoothly on a laptop takes a lot of effort in terms of hardware firepower, not to mention a dedicated graphics processing unit (or GPU) with dedicated RAM. When a laptop with 15-inch Full HD screen, an Intel Core i7 CPU with 16GB of DDR3 RAM, 1TB HDD and 4GB DDR5 NVIDIA GTX 1060 GPU is trying to run a game like Mafia III on max setting, you can feel it working on over-drive – moreso if it's running on battery power alone. And this match, the poor battery is thoroughly outmatched.

speed might involve trade offs on other features that are equally important for gaming. For instance, in the quest of getting a superior Intel Core i7 quad-core processor clocked at higher speed versus Intel Core i5 processor clocked at slightly lower speed, cost-wise the Core i5 configuration may be able to fit in a Full HD screen and greater RAM capacity than the Intel Core i7 (because it costs more, meaning you have to settle for a low resolution screen or lesser RAM).

Matte screens for reading text or glossy screen for pretty visuals?

Big keyboard to type or easy to carry around? What's best for writers and bloggers? Any writer worth his salt has



Choosing the right laptop for your budget as well as your needs might be tough

For the configuration mentioned above, you'd be lucky if the battery lasts anything over 90 minutes on continuous gameplay – whether it's a 3-cell or 4-cell battery, doesn't matter. Which means, you'd perpetually have to keep a gaming laptop connected to a power source, as you can't really expect a whole lot as far as its battery life's concerned. So yeah, with great performance comes inferior battery life on a gaming laptop. That's just how life is.

Also CPU clock speeds matter on a gaming laptop but higher clock

to do two things a lot -- type and watch the screen. For hours on end. So, obviously, typing comfort and eye strain are of utmost importance to a writer.

The tradeoffs to consider while buying a laptop for writing or blogging is this. Do you want a small, tiny laptop that's easy to carry around or a full keyboard that's easy to type on? Keyboard properties to look at are -- full-sized, bevelled or curved keys, keyboard flex, and layout. A minimum of a 13-inch screen size (15-inch is ideal) ensures at least the keyboard has full-sized